Brandon Decker

Ph.D. Candidate, School of Public and International Affairs, University of Georgia
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EDUCATION

University of Georgia Athens, GA
Ph.D. in Political Science *Expected May 2027*
Major Field: American Politics; Minor Field: Political Methodology

University of Kansas Lawrence, KS
M.A. in Political Science *May 2022*
Specialization: Political Behavior and American Institutions

University of Kansas Lawrence, KS
B.A. in Political Science; Minor in Philosophy *May 2020*

RESEARCH INTERESTS

American political institutions; congressional behavior; separation of powers; electoral behavior; political methodology; spatial modeling; time series analysis.

WORKING PAPERS

- "Donor Coalition Evolution and Congressional Career Trajectory." Working paper.
- "I'm Very Comfortable Where I Am: Static Ambition in the U.S. House of Representatives." Working paper.
- Vande Kamp, Garrett, and Brandon Decker. "Accounting for Measurement Error in Spatially Lagged Variables." Working paper.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- Decker, Brandon. "Donor Coalition Evolution and Congressional Career Trajectory." Presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, IL, 2026.
- Decker, Brandon. "The Moderating Effects of Conspiratorial Ideology on Opinions Towards Gun Policy." Presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, IL, 2024.
- Vande Kamp, Garrett, and Brandon Decker. "Accounting for Measurement Error in Spatially Lagged Variables." Presented at the Annual Meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, IL, 2024.
- Decker, Brandon. "He's (Not) Our Rogue Leader." Presented at the South Carolina Political Science Association Annual Conference, University of Charleston, 2024.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Dr. Garrett Vande Kamp Fall 2023; Spring 2024; Fall 2024; Spring 2025

University of Georgia *Athens, GA*
Assisted with research on measurement error in spatially lagged variables, including projects involving spatial autoregressive models, spatial lag of X models, and spatial Durbin models.

Research Assistant to Dr. David Cottrell and Dr. Christina Boyd Fall 2022; Spring 2023
University of Georgia *Athens, GA*
Collected, coded, and organized candidate statements of intention to run for office in southern states using R and Excel.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record, POLS 1101: Introduction to American Politics Fall 2026
University of Georgia *Athens, GA*
Forthcoming.

Graduate Teaching Assistant, POLS 1101: Introduction to American Politics Spring 2026; Summer 2026
University of Georgia *Athens, GA*
Instructor of record/supervising instructor: Dr. Jeffrey Glas.

Graduate Teaching Assistant, POLS 1101: Introduction to American Politics Fall 2025
University of Georgia *Athens, GA*
Instructor of record/supervising instructor: Dr. Alexa Bankert.

Graduate Teaching Assistant, POLS 1101: Introduction to American Politics Summer 2025
University of Georgia *Athens, GA*
Instructor of record/supervising instructor: Dr. Jeffrey Glas.

Graduate Teaching Assistant, POLS 1101: Introduction to American Politics Summer 2023
University of Georgia *Athens, GA*
Instructor of record/supervising instructor: Dr. Jeffrey Glas. Enrollment: 54 students.

Graduate Teaching Assistant, POLS 110: Introduction to American Politics Fall 2021; Spring 2022
University of Kansas *Lawrence, KS*
Instructor of record/supervising instructor: Dr. Mark Joslyn. Enrollment: 60 students.

METHODS TRAINING

University of Georgia: Applied Bayesian Modeling; Computational Data Analysis; Ordinary Least Squares; Text-as-Data; Maximum Likelihood Estimation; Spatial Modeling; Time Series Analysis; Game Theory; Research Design; Introduction to Political Methodology.

University of Kansas: Ordinary Least Squares; Maximum Likelihood Estimation; Time Series Analysis; Agent-Based Modeling; Research Design; Introduction to Political Methodology.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming and Markup: R, Stata, NetLogo, LaTeX, Python.
Software: Qualtrics, RStudio, Emacs, Excel.

FELLOWSHIPS, AWARDS, AND FUNDING

- Outstanding Early Career Teaching Assistant for 1101, University of Georgia, Spring 2026.
- Full Tuition Scholarship, University of Georgia, 2022–2027.
- Graduate Assistantship, University of Georgia, 2022–2027.
- Full Tuition Scholarship, University of Kansas, 2021–2022.
- Graduate Assistantship, University of Kansas, 2021–2022.
- Student Senate Finance Award, University of Kansas, 2021.
- Bogdon-Pacey-Maginness Award, University of Kansas, 2021.

SERVICE AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Student Senator, University of Kansas, 2017–2021.
- Veterans Affairs Student Liaison, University of Kansas, 2017–2021.
- Vice President, Student Veterans of America, University of Kansas, 2018–2020.
- Congressional District Intern, Office of Representative Duncan Hunter, 50th Congressional District, 2018.
- Campaign Staff, Campaign to Re-Elect Duncan Hunter.